

MAKEUP SALES

DASHBOARD DOCUMENTATION

A Student Project Report

Subject: Data Analytics & Visualization
Tool Used: Microsoft Excel
Dataset: Makeup Sales Data (500 Records)
Year: 2025

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Academic Year: 2024–2025

1. Introduction

The makeup and beauty industry is one of the fastest-growing sectors in the world. Companies that sell beauty products need to understand how their products are performing across different regions, channels, and customer groups. Without proper data analysis, it becomes difficult to make smart business decisions.

This project presents a set of interactive Excel dashboards built using real-world-style makeup sales data. The dashboards are designed to help analysts, students, and business teams quickly understand sales trends, product performance, and customer purchasing behavior.

The project covers three main dashboards: a Revenue Dashboard, a Product Analysis Dashboard, and a Sales Performance Dashboard. Together, they provide a complete picture of how the business is performing.

2. Objectives

The main objectives of this project are:

- To analyze makeup product sales data across multiple countries and sales channels.
- To identify top-performing products, brands, and product categories.
- To understand which sales channels and payment methods generate the most revenue.
- To discover which countries contribute most to total revenue.
- To present the findings clearly using visual dashboards in Microsoft Excel.
- To provide useful business recommendations based on the data findings.

3. Dataset Description

The dataset used in this project contains 500 sales records related to the makeup and cosmetics industry. Each record represents one transaction. Below is a description of the dataset columns:

Column Name	Data Type	Description
Sale_ID	Number	A unique number assigned to each sale transaction

Date	Date	The date when the sale took place
Brand	Text	The name of the makeup brand (e.g., MAC, L'Oreal, Dior)
Product_Type	Text	The category of the product (e.g., Lipstick, Mascara)
Country	Text	The country where the sale was made
Sales_Channel	Text	How the product was sold (Online, Retail Store, Mall, Beauty Salon)
Payment_Method	Text	How the customer paid (Card, Cash, Digital Wallet)
Price_USD	Number	The price of the product in US Dollars
Units_Sold	Number	The number of units sold in that transaction
Revenue_USD	Number	Total revenue from the transaction (Price × Units Sold)

Key Dataset Facts:

Total Records	500 transactions
Time Period	2025 (Full Year)
Number of Brands	8 brands
Number of Countries	8 countries
Product Categories	8 types
Sales Channels	4 channels
Payment Methods	3 methods
Total Revenue	\$793,188.50 USD

4. Tools Used

Tool	Purpose
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Microsoft Excel	Main tool used to build all dashboards, charts, pivot tables, and slicers. All visual elements and data analysis were done in Excel.
Pivot Tables	Used to summarize and group large amounts of data into useful reports. Each chart in the dashboards is powered by a pivot table.
Slicers	Interactive filters added to dashboards so users can click buttons to filter data by country, channel, brand, or date.
Charts & Graphs	Bar charts, pie charts, column charts, and line charts were used to display data in a visual and easy-to-understand format.
Timeline Filter	A special date filter in Excel that allows users to filter data by month or year using a sliding timeline control.
Conditional Formatting	Used to highlight important data, such as top-performing products or countries, using color-coded cells.

5. Dashboard Explanation

This project contains three dashboards, each focused on a different aspect of the business. Below is a detailed explanation of each dashboard and the visuals it contains.

5.1 Revenue Dashboard

This dashboard gives a high-level overview of total revenue. It helps users understand which countries are generating the most sales and allows filtering by country and sales channel.

Charts & Visuals Included:

Revenue by Country (Bar Chart)

This bar chart shows the total revenue generated by each of the 8 countries in the dataset. Saudi Arabia leads with \$120,778, followed by UK (\$115,360), India (\$109,638), USA (\$96,006), UAE (\$93,568), Germany (\$92,126), Canada (\$85,349), and France (\$80,364). This chart makes it easy to compare country-level performance at a glance.

Slicers (Interactive Filters)

Two slicers are added to this dashboard:

- Country Slicer — Allows the user to select one or more countries. The chart immediately updates to show data for only the selected countries.

- Sales Channel Slicer — Allows the user to filter by how the product was sold: Online, Retail Store, Mall, or Beauty Salon.

These slicers make the dashboard interactive. Instead of looking at all data at once, the user can focus on specific segments.

5.2 Product Analysis Dashboard

This dashboard focuses on product-level performance. It helps identify which products and brands are driving the most sales, which product categories are popular, and how much each product contributes to total revenue.

Charts & Visuals Included:

Top Selling Products (Bar Chart)

This chart ranks all 8 product types by total revenue. Mascara leads with \$116,135, followed by Eyeshadow (\$104,839), Eyeliner (\$104,736), Highlighter (\$99,516), Concealer (\$98,216), Foundation (\$96,757), Blush (\$89,158), and Lipstick (\$83,831). Eye products clearly dominate in terms of revenue.

Top Performing Brands (Column Chart)

This chart shows which brands generate the highest revenue. MAC is the top brand with \$155,246, followed by L'Oreal (\$123,593), Dior (\$99,811), Fenty Beauty (\$95,002), NARS (\$88,793), Estee Lauder (\$86,983), Huda Beauty (\$76,357), and Maybelline (\$67,404). This helps the business understand where to invest in brand partnerships or stock.

Sales by Product Type / Category (Column or Bar Chart)

This chart shows how each makeup category (Blush, Concealer, Eyeliner, Eyeshadow, Foundation, Highlighter, Lipstick, Mascara) compares in terms of total revenue and units sold. It helps identify which categories are strong and which may need more attention.

Product Contribution (Pie Chart)

This pie chart shows the percentage share of each product type in total revenue. Since revenue is fairly spread across all 8 categories (ranging from about 10.6% to 14.6%), no single product completely dominates, but Mascara, Eyeshadow, and Eyeliner hold the largest slices. The pie chart gives a quick visual sense of revenue distribution.

Timeline Filter

A timeline is added to this dashboard, allowing users to select a specific time range (e.g., January to March, or the full year). This makes it easy to analyze how product sales changed over different months.

Slicers

Additional slicers are available so users can filter the product analysis by country, brand, or sales channel, giving a more focused view of the data.

5.3 Sales Performance Dashboard

This dashboard focuses on how and where sales happen. It analyzes payment methods, countries, units sold, and brand performance to help the business understand customer behavior and improve operations.

Charts & Visuals Included:

Revenue by Payment Method (Bar Chart)

This chart compares how much revenue was collected through each payment method. Digital Wallet is the highest with \$290,528, followed by Card (\$282,922) and Cash (\$219,739). This shows that digital and card payments are preferred by most customers.

Revenue by Country (Bar Chart)

Similar to the Revenue Dashboard, this chart shows revenue by country but within the context of overall sales performance. It reinforces the finding that Saudi Arabia and UK are the strongest markets.

Units Sold by Payment Method (Bar Chart)

This chart shows the number of product units sold through each payment method. It provides a different view from the revenue chart, showing not just how much money was made, but how many items were bought. This helps understand volume versus value differences across payment methods.

Units Sold by Brand (Column Chart)

This chart compares the volume of units sold for each brand. Brands that sell many units at lower prices may still generate good revenue overall. This chart helps distinguish between high-volume brands and high-value brands.

6. Insights & Recommendations

Based on the analysis of the makeup sales data across all three dashboards, the following insights and recommendations have been identified:

6.1 Product Categories

Finding: Some product categories perform significantly better than others in terms of total revenue.

Product Category	Total Revenue (USD)	Performance
Mascara	\$116,135	★ Top Performer
Eyeshadow	\$104,839	★ Top Performer
Eyelineer	\$104,736	★ Top Performer
Highlighter	\$99,516	✔ Strong
Concealer	\$98,216	✔ Strong
Foundation	\$96,757	✔ Strong
Blush	\$89,158	⚠ Moderate
Lipstick	\$83,831	⚠ Needs Attention

Recommendations:

- Increase inventory and marketing investment for top-performing eye products (Mascara, Eyeshadow, Eyelineer), as these show the strongest sales.
- Investigate why Lipstick is the lowest-performing category and consider refreshing product lines, running promotions, or bundling Lipstick with popular eye products to improve sales.
- Blush also has room for improvement. Targeted social media campaigns or influencer promotions could help boost its visibility.

6.2 Sales Channels

Finding: Different sales channels contribute differently to total revenue. Online is the strongest channel.

Sales Channel	Total Revenue (USD)	Performance
Online	\$224,883	★ Top Performer
Retail Store	\$202,425	✔ Strong
Mall	\$189,931	✔ Strong
Beauty Salon	\$175,949	⚠ Needs Attention

Recommendations:

- Invest more in the Online channel through better website experience, digital advertising, and exclusive online deals. Online already leads and has the most potential for growth.
- Retail Stores perform well and should be maintained with strong in-store displays and promotions to keep foot traffic high.
- Beauty Salon is the weakest channel. The business should consider whether partnerships with salons need improvement, or if some salon locations should be replaced with stronger channels.

6.3 Country Performance

Finding: Saudi Arabia and UK are the highest revenue-generating countries. France is the weakest market.

Country	Total Revenue (USD)	Performance
Saudi Arabia	\$120,778	★ Top Performer
UK	\$115,360	★ Top Performer
India	\$109,638	✔ Strong
USA	\$96,006	✔ Strong
UAE	\$93,568	✔ Moderate
Germany	\$92,126	✔ Moderate
Canada	\$85,349	⚠ Needs Attention
France	\$80,364	⚠ Weakest Market

Recommendations:

- Expand operations and marketing efforts in Saudi Arabia and UK, which are clearly the strongest markets.
- India shows strong growth potential given its large population and growing beauty market. More investment here could yield excellent returns.

- France and Canada are underperforming. The business should research whether this is due to pricing, product preferences, or low brand awareness, and take corrective action.

6.4 Top Brands and Products

Finding: MAC and L’Oreal are the two strongest brands. Maybelline and Huda Beauty are the weakest performers.

Brand	Total Revenue (USD)	Performance
MAC	\$155,246	★ Top Performer
L’Oreal	\$123,593	★ Top Performer
Dior	\$99,811	✔ Strong
Fenty Beauty	\$95,002	✔ Strong
NARS	\$88,793	✔ Moderate
Estee Lauder	\$86,983	✔ Moderate
Huda Beauty	\$76,357	⚠ Needs Attention
Maybelline	\$67,404	⚠ Weakest Brand

Recommendations:

- Prioritize MAC and L’Oreal in inventory planning, as these two brands drive the most revenue. Ensure they are always well-stocked.
- Maybelline, despite being a globally popular brand, is the weakest performer in this dataset. The business should investigate whether pricing strategy, product mix, or marketing is limiting its performance.
- Huda Beauty has strong brand recognition. A targeted influencer campaign or exclusive product launch could help boost its sales numbers.
- Dior and Fenty Beauty are solid mid-tier performers. With the right promotions, these brands could reach the top tier.

6.5 Payment Methods

Finding: Digital Wallet is the most popular payment method, followed closely by Card. Cash is the least used.

Recommendations:

- Ensure all sales channels support Digital Wallet and Card payments, as these are the preferred payment methods.
- Offer incentives such as cashback or discounts for Digital Wallet payments to encourage its continued use.
- Cash is declining in preference. Reducing reliance on cash-only operations can speed up checkout times and reduce handling costs.

7. Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates how Microsoft Excel can be used to build informative, interactive dashboards from sales data. The three dashboards — Revenue Dashboard, Product Analysis Dashboard, and Sales Performance Dashboard — together provide a complete view of the makeup business.

Through this analysis, several key findings were identified:

- Eye makeup products, particularly Mascara, Eyeshadow, and Eyeliner, are the best-performing product categories.
- MAC and L’Oreal are the top revenue-generating brands.
- Saudi Arabia and UK are the strongest markets geographically.
- Online is the most effective sales channel.
- Digital Wallet is the most preferred payment method by customers.

The dashboards make it easy for any user — even without a technical background — to explore the data using slicers and timeline filters. The visual nature of the charts makes the findings clear and easy to communicate.

The insights and recommendations provided in this report can help the business make better decisions around inventory management, marketing, channel investment, and geographic expansion. By focusing resources on high-performing products, brands, and markets, the business can grow more efficiently.

Overall, this project shows the power of data analysis and visualization in turning raw numbers into meaningful business intelligence.

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